



The Tour de France takes place over three weeks every summer. It covers more than 2,175 miles (3,500 km), broken up into 21 stages. Each year, the route across France changes, sometimes entering other European countries, but it always challenges riders over all sorts of terrain, with stages on the flat, in the hills, and in the mountains. Around 20 teams take

part, each with nine riders. The cyclists' times for each day are added together and the rider with the overall lowest time gets to wear the prized *maillot jaune* (yellow jersey). But there are also prizes for the fastest sprinter (green jersey), the fastest climber (red polka dot jersey), the fastest rider under 25 (white jersey), and for the fastest team.